Season 1: The Fall of the Wall

Attack on Titan - Detailed Season Summary (Episodes 1-25)

Season: 1 | **Episodes:** 25 | **Original run:** April - September 2013

Story arcs: Fall of Wall Maria, 104th Training Corps, Battle of Trost District, 57th Expedition, Female Titan arc (Stohess)

Key characters: Eren Yeager, Mikasa Ackerman, Armin Arlert, Levi, Erwin Smith, Hange Zoe, Annie Leonhart, Reiner Braun, Bertholdt Hoover

Spoiler warning: this document summarises the anime in full, including major twists and the ending of the season described.

1. Season Overview

Season 1 of Attack on Titan introduces a world in which the last remnants of humanity live inside three enormous concentric walls, protected from man-eating giants called Titans. The season follows Eren Yeager, his adoptive sister Mikasa Ackerman and their friend Armin Arlert from the day the outermost wall is broken, through their military training, to their first real battles against the Titans and the shocking discovery that the enemy is not only outside the walls but also hiding among their own comrades. It is a story of survival, revenge, fear and the cost of freedom, and it ends with far more questions than answers.

2. The World and Its Rules

Humanity lives behind three walls: Wall Maria (the outermost), Wall Rose (the middle) and Wall Sina (the innermost, which protects the capital and the royal government). For about a hundred years before the story begins, no Titan has breached them. Titans are humanoid giants, usually between three and fifteen metres tall, with no apparent need to eat; they devour humans anyway. They regenerate from almost any wound, and the only reliable way to kill one is to cut out the weak point at the back of the neck. Soldiers fight them using Vertical Maneuvering Equipment (also called 3D Maneuver Gear), a harness with grappling hooks, compressed gas and twin blades that lets a person swing through the air at high speed.

Military society is divided into three branches. The Garrison Regiment guards the walls and the cities. The Military Police Brigade keeps order inside Wall Sina and is considered the most comfortable and privileged posting. The Survey Corps ventures outside the walls to study Titans and explore the world, and suffers terrible casualties; most people regard its members as brave but doomed.

3. Major Characters in Season 1

Eren Yeager is a hot-headed boy who dreams of destroying every Titan after watching his mother killed in front of him. Over the season he discovers he can transform into a Titan himself. **Mikasa Ackerman** is Eren's adoptive sister, an extraordinarily gifted fighter who is fiercely protective of him. **Armin Arlert** is physically weak but a brilliant strategist whose plans repeatedly save the group. **Levi Ackerman** is the Survey Corps' strongest soldier, a short, sharp-tongued and ruthlessly efficient captain. **Erwin Smith** is the calculating Commander of the Survey Corps. **Hange Zoe** is an eccentric squad leader obsessed with studying Titans. **Keith Shadis** is the harsh drill instructor of the cadets. **Dot Pixis** is the Garrison's eccentric but brilliant commander. **Grisha Yeager** is Eren's father, a doctor who vanishes after the fall of Wall Maria, and **Carla Yeager** is Eren's mother.

The 104th Training Corps cadets include **Reiner Braun** (a dependable, soldierly leader), **Bertholdt Hoover** (tall, shy and anxious), **Annie Leonhart** (cold, solitary and a skilled fighter), **Jean Kirstein** (blunt and ambitious), **Marco Bott** (kind and principled), **Connie Springer** (cheerful), **Sasha Braus** (a hunter with a huge appetite), **Krista Lenz** (gentle and selfless) and **Ymir** (sharp-tongued and protective of Krista). The elite Special Operations Squad of Levi includes **Petra Ral, Oluo Bossard, Eld Jinn and Gunther Schultz**.

4. Detailed Plot Summary

Arc 1 - The Fall of Wall Maria (Year 845)

Ten-year-old Eren lives in Shiganshina District, the frontier town on the edge of Wall Maria. He is frustrated that people accept living like livestock inside walls, and he is angry when townspeople mock the battered Survey Corps as it returns. Then the unthinkable happens: a Titan taller than the wall itself, the Colossal Titan, appears and kicks the gate to pieces. Smaller Titans pour into the district. Eren's mother Carla is trapped beneath their collapsed house. Hannes, a Garrison soldier and family friend, tries to help but is too frightened to fight, and Eren watches a Titan devour his mother. A second giant, the Armored Titan, then shatters the inner gate, and Wall Maria is lost. Eren, Mikasa and Armin escape with the refugees to Wall Rose, where overcrowding and food shortages follow. A government attempt to relieve the pressure by sending refugees to retake the lost territory ends in a massacre. Eren swears that he will wipe out every Titan.

Arc 2 - The 104th Training Corps (Year 850)

Five years later Eren, Mikasa and Armin join the 104th Training Corps. Under the brutal Instructor Keith Shadis the cadets learn to use 3D Maneuver Gear and fight Titans. Eren struggles at first with the balance exercise and is nearly dismissed, but eventually succeeds. Mikasa is the top cadet, Reiner and Bertholdt are among the best, and Armin proves himself in tactical thinking rather than physical skill. The cadets also form lasting friendships and rivalries: Jean and Eren clash constantly, Sasha is caught stealing a potato, and Krista earns a reputation for kindness. Graduates ranked in the top ten are entitled to join the Military Police, and everyone else must choose between the Garrison and the Survey Corps, but the branches have not yet been chosen when disaster strikes.

Arc 3 - The Battle of Trost District

On the day the graduates are officially assigned, the Colossal Titan appears again, this time in Trost District of Wall Rose, and blasts a hole through the gate. The Garrison's defences collapse, and the newly graduated cadets are thrown into combat without preparation. Many die, including Marco. Armin's squad is trapped; Eren saves Armin but is swallowed by a Titan while doing so. Mikasa, believing Eren dead, fights desperately until a strange, nearly uncontrollable Titan appears and starts killing other Titans. Armin works out the truth: the Titan is Eren, who has transformed. Garrison commander Dot Pixis decides to trust Armin's plan, which is to have Eren, in Titan form, lift a giant boulder and seal the hole in the gate. After a chaotic fight, Eren's Titan manages to seal the breach. After the battle the surviving cadets must choose their branches. Eren, Mikasa, Armin and most of their friends commit to the Survey Corps, while Annie, who ranked among the best, takes the Military Police. The immediate threat is over, but the humans now face a new dilemma: is Eren a hero or a monster?

Arc 4 - Eren's Trial and the Survey Corps

Eren is arrested and brought before a military tribunal. The Military Police want to dissect him, the Garrison fears him, and the Survey Corps wants to use him. Erwin and Levi argue that Eren is a weapon

that can turn the tide. Levi dramatically beats Eren during the hearing to show he can be controlled. Erwin takes custody, and Eren is assigned to the Special Operations Squad under Levi. Their training missions show how dangerous Eren's power is: when he tries to transform without a clear goal, he sometimes loses control and nearly kills his friends. Hange also runs experiments on two captured Titans, nicknamed Sawney and Bean, and learns more about their behaviour, until both are murdered by unknown attackers. The Corps starts to suspect there are people among them with an unknown agenda.

Arc 5 - The 57th Expedition and the Female Titan

The Survey Corps leaves the walls for the 57th expedition in a special formation designed by Erwin to spot and trap unusual Titans, with Eren hidden in the centre. An intelligent Titan, later called the Female Titan, appears and begins slaughtering everyone who stands between her and Eren. Levi's squad, unable to trust Eren to transform, is annihilated in the forest; Eren, in desperation, finally transforms but is outmatched and captured. Levi and Mikasa rescue him, but the cost is heavy: Petra, Oluo, Eld and Gunther are dead, and Levi is shaken. Erwin, who gambled with the lives of many soldiers, is publicly condemned by the people he tried to protect.

Arc 6 - The Capture of the Female Titan in Stohess

Armin deduces that the Female Titan must be a cadet from the 104th, because she moved like a trained soldier and sought Eren specifically. Armin, Eren and Mikasa come to suspect Annie Leonhart. Erwin and Levi stage a trap in Stohess District in Wall Sina, using Eren as bait. Annie is lured into an underground tunnel but transforms into the Female Titan and breaks through the city, killing many civilians as she flees. Eren transforms and fights her in the streets. After a fierce battle, Annie is cornered, but before she can be captured she encases herself in a crystal. She cannot be woken or harmed, and she leaves behind more questions than answers.

5. Key Revelations of Season 1

(1) Eren can transform into a Titan, and some people possess the power to become Titans at will. (2) The Female Titan is Annie Leonhart, which proves that the enemy has infiltrated humanity's own ranks. (3) Titans can be intelligent and can plan. (4) The giants that breached Wall Maria are connected to the people who are now hunting Eren. (5) Hidden inside the walls themselves are enormous Titans, a discovery that hints that the walls are not what the government claimed. (6) Eren has a hidden connection to his father's mysterious past, including a key and a basement that he does not yet understand.

6. How the Story Progresses

Season 1 starts as a straightforward survival story and slowly becomes a mystery. The early episodes focus on loss and fear. Trost shows that humanity can fight back, and Eren's power gives it a weapon, but the Female Titan arc turns the story into a conspiracy thriller in which friends can be enemies. By the end, Eren has learned that his mission to kill all Titans is far more complicated than he thought, and the Survey Corps knows that someone intelligent is waiting inside the walls. Season 2 picks up directly from the aftermath of Stohess, with Annie in her crystal and the question of who else might be hiding in the shadows.